

Richard Laken Harville

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TECHNICAL SUMMARY

Software Engineer and Applied Computer Science graduate student (May 2026) with hands-on experience across the full stack from React and Three.js frontends to Rails and ASP.NET backends to cloud-deployed services and relational databases. Has fine-tuned a large language model end-to-end, deployed a full-stack web service on a Linux cloud VM, and designed normalized schemas for multi-entity applications. Comfortable building in Python, Java, C#, JavaScript, SQL, and Ruby. Values clean code, thorough testing, clear documentation, and learning something new with every project.

EDUCATION

University of West Georgia <i>Master of Science in Applied Computer Science</i> (Expected May 2026) – Relevant Coursework: Software Engineering, Database Systems, Machine Learning, Distributed Application Development	Carrollton, GA <i>Aug. 2024 – Present</i>
Kennesaw State University <i>Bachelor of Science in Psychology</i>	Kennesaw, GA <i>Aug. 2016 – May 2021</i>
TrueCoders <i>Full-Stack Software Engineering Certificate</i>	Birmingham, AL <i>Oct. 2022</i>

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages: Python, Java, C#, JavaScript, SQL, Ruby, HTML/CSS
Frontend: React, React Three Fiber, Three.js, responsive design, Bootstrap
Backend & APIs: REST API design & integration, ASP.NET MVC, .NET 8, Ruby on Rails, Flask, MVC architecture, microservices patterns
Databases: SQL Server / SSMS, relational schema design (ER / crow's foot), normalization, parameterized queries, ORMs
AI / ML: PyTorch, HuggingFace Transformers, LLM fine-tuning (Qwen3), prompt engineering, XGBoost, SHAP, LIME, Jupyter
Cloud & Tools: Microsoft Azure (VMs, SQL Server), Linux (Ubuntu), SSH, Git / GitHub, Visual Studio, VS Code, Postman
Practices: Object-oriented design, unit & functional testing, code review, Agile development, root-cause debugging, technical documentation

PROJECTS

SplitTheCheck: Full-Stack Web Service <i>Ruby on Rails 8, REST, MVC, SQL, Azure VM, Git</i> – Designed and built a full-stack web application with RESTful routes, MVC separation, and Active Record models for user-generated content and aggregated vote tallies. – Deployed and operated the service end-to-end on a Microsoft Azure Ubuntu VM, configuring the runtime environment, dependencies, and SSH-based deployment workflow from scratch. – Wrote integration tests with Rails' built-in framework, used Git for version control, and iterated on the application through review feedback in an agile, code-review-driven workflow.	2026
Explainable AI Pipeline with Fine-Tuned LLM <i>Python, PyTorch, HuggingFace, XGBoost, SHAP, LIME</i> – Built an end-to-end Explainable AI pipeline integrating an XGBoost classifier with SHAP and LIME explanation layers, counterfactual reasoning, and dimensionality reduction visualizations (PCA, t-SNE, UMAP). – Fine-tuned a Qwen3-0.6B foundation model on a custom instruction dataset, building a flexible text-extraction helper to handle nested conversation structures and resolve tokenization edge cases. – Implemented guardrail prompts to constrain model outputs and pushed the trained model to HuggingFace Hub, demonstrating practical experience with the modern GenAI tooling ecosystem.	2025
Interactive 3D Developer Portfolio <i>React, React Three Fiber, Three.js, JavaScript</i> – Designed and built a distinctive portfolio site that uses an explorable 3D environment as the primary navigation mechanic, demonstrating a strong eye for user experience and modern frontend craft.	2026

- Implemented the 3D scene with React Three Fiber and Three.js, managing component state, animation loops, and asset loading inside a React component tree for performance and maintainability.
- Iterated continuously on layout, styling, and interaction patterns, treating each version as a learning input and shipping working software at every stage.

EXPERIENCE

TEALS Volunteer Instructor (Technology Education And Literacy in Schools) Aug. 2023 – May 2024

Paul Bryant High School

Tuscaloosa, AL

- Mentored students in Python and Java, guiding them through debugging, testing, and systematic problem-solving.
- Adapted explanations to a wide range of skill levels, practicing the clear communication needed on cross-functional engineering teams.

Account Merchandiser

Aug. 2023 – Nov. 2024

Buffalo Rock Company

Tuscaloosa, AL

- Managed structured workflows across multiple accounts under shifting requirements, resolving operational issues through clear escalation and collaboration.

Deli Clerk

Sep. 2021 – Aug. 2023, Dec. 2024 – Present

Publix Super Markets

Atlanta, GA

- Resolved high-pressure customer-facing issues with rapid problem-solving and accuracy. Trained new team members and documented procedures.

Department Supervisor / Warehouse Associate

March 2017 – July 2021

The Home Depot

Atlanta, GA; McCalla, AL

- Led teams in high-volume environments with a focus on efficiency, decision-making, and mentoring associates on best practices.